

STUDY SHEET: BLOCK 6 (Chapter 6 - 'A Merry Christmas, Mr Scrooge!')

1) Plot (Trama)

Scrooge wakes up in his own bed and realizes he is alive and that the Spirits have done all their work in one single night. It is Christmas morning. He is completely transformed and full of joy. He opens the window and asks a young boy in the street what day it is. When he finds out it is Christmas Day, he pays the boy to go and buy the biggest prize turkey from the poulterer and sends it anonymously to Bob Cratchit's house.

Scrooge dresses in his best clothes and walks the streets of London, smiling and greeting everyone. He meets the portly gentleman he chased away the day before and promises him a huge donation for the poor. Then, he finally goes to his nephew Fred's house for Christmas dinner. Fred and his wife welcome him with open arms, and Scrooge has a wonderful time. The next morning (Boxing Day), Scrooge goes to the office early to catch Bob Cratchit arriving late. When Bob arrives, Scrooge pretends to be his old, angry self. However, he suddenly changes his attitude, wishes Bob a Merry Christmas, raises his salary, and promises to help his family. In the end, the narrator explains that Scrooge became a good, generous man and a second father to Tiny Tim, who did not die. Scrooge kept the Christmas spirit alive in his heart for the rest of his life.

2) Characters (Personaggi)

Character	Role & Development
Ebenezer Scrooge	He completes his transformation. He changes from a miserable, greedy old man into a generous, joyful, and loving person. He laughs, gives away money, and finally enjoys Christmas.
The Boy in the Street	A normal boy who informs Scrooge that it is Christmas Day. Scrooge pays him to run and buy the giant turkey.
Fred (Scrooge's Nephew)	He represents absolute forgiveness. Despite

Character	Role & Development
	how badly Scrooge treated him, Fred immediately welcomes him to the family dinner with joy.
Bob Cratchit	He arrives late to work on December 26th and is terrified of being fired. He is absolutely shocked and overwhelmed with gratitude when Scrooge raises his salary.
Tiny Tim	It is revealed at the end of the chapter that he survives thanks to Scrooge's financial help and newfound care for the Cratchit family.

3) Themes (Tematiche)

- **Redemption and Second Chances:** This is the most important theme of the chapter. Scrooge proves that it is never too late to change and become a better person.
- **The Christmas Spirit:** The chapter explodes with joy, generosity, and kindness, showing the true meaning of Christmas that Scrooge has finally embraced.
- **Family and Forgiveness:** Shown through Fred, who forgives his uncle's past behavior without hesitation and accepts him back into the family.

4) Useful Vocabulary (Vocabolario utile)

English Word / Phrase	Italian Translation
Redemption	Redenzione / Riscatto
Turkey	Tacchino (the prize turkey = il tacchino gigante in vetrina)
To raise a salary	Aumentare lo stipendio
To laugh / chuckle	Ridere / Ridacchiare (Scrooge finally laughs!)
Anonymous / Anonymously	Anonimo / In modo anonimo (how he sends

English Word / Phrase	Italian Translation
	the turkey)

5) Possible Test Questions & Short Answers

- Q1: What does Scrooge do immediately after waking up on Christmas morning?**
Answer: He is extremely happy to be alive. He asks a boy what day it is and pays him to buy a giant prize turkey to send to the Cratchit family.
- Q2: How does Scrooge make amends (rimedia) with the portly gentleman he met in Chapter 1?**
Answer: Scrooge meets him in the street and promises to give him a very large donation for the poor.
- Q3: How does Fred react when Scrooge arrives at his house for dinner?**
Answer: Fred is completely surprised but very happy. He welcomes Scrooge warmly and forgives him instantly.
- Q4: Describe what happens at the office between Scrooge and Bob Cratchit the day after Christmas.**
Answer: Bob arrives late. Scrooge pretends to be very angry to scare him, but then he smiles, wishes him a Merry Christmas, and raises his salary.
- Q5: What happens to Tiny Tim at the end of the story?**
Answer: Tiny Tim does not die. Because Scrooge becomes a good friend and a "second father" to the family, Tim survives and thrives.